

Semaglutide

Semaglutide (Ozempic / Wegovy)

FAT LOSS DIABETES CARDIOVASCULAR APPETITE FDA APPROVED

WHAT IS IT?

Semaglutide is a long-acting GLP-1 receptor agonist approved by the FDA for type 2 diabetes (Ozempic) and chronic weight management (Wegovy). SELECT trial data showed a 20% reduction in major cardiovascular events in non-diabetic patients. Produces 15–17% body weight reduction at maximum doses in clinical trials.

DOSING AT A GLANCE

Starting Dose	Max (Wegovy)	Frequency	Protocol
0.25 mg/wk	2.4 mg/wk	Once weekly	4-week titration

KEY BENEFITS

- 15–17% body weight reduction at 2.4 mg/week (Wegovy) in SURMOUNT trials
- 20% reduction in cardiovascular events (SELECT trial, 2023)
- Significant HbA1c reduction in T2DM
- Reduced liver fat and improvement in NASH markers
- Blood pressure reduction (systolic -4–5 mmHg)
- Improved lipid profile (LDL, triglycerides)
- Appetite suppression and reduced food cravings
- Addictive behavior reduction (alcohol, nicotine — emerging data)

HOW IT WORKS

Semaglutide binds GLP-1 receptors in the gut (slowing gastric emptying, increasing satiety), pancreas (stimulating insulin, inhibiting glucagon), brain (appetite centers in hypothalamus and brainstem), and cardiovascular system. Its fatty acid side chain extends half-life to ~1 week via albumin binding.

PROTOCOLS

- **Ozempic (diabetes):** 0.25 mg weekly x4 → 0.5 mg x4 → 1 mg x4 → 2 mg.
- **Wegovy (obesity):** 0.25 mg x4 → 0.5 → 1.0 → 1.7 → 2.4 mg (each 4 weeks).
- **Compounded:** Slower titration to minimize GI side effects.

- **Protein:** 1g/lb body weight minimum to preserve lean mass during loss.

SIDE EFFECTS

- Nausea (most common — diminishes over weeks)
- Vomiting, diarrhea, constipation
- Gastroparesis risk with long-term use
- Muscle mass loss (offset with protein + resistance training)
- Pancreatitis (rare)
- Injection site reactions

STORAGE

Refrigerate 2–8°C. Do not freeze. After first use, room temp up to 28 days (pen).

■ ***Contraindicated in personal/family history of MTC or MEN2. Pancreatitis — discontinue if severe abdominal pain develops.***

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